A PRODUCT AND BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE CASE STUDY

After the Launch Party

What happened to thirty flagship AI features one year after launch, and the patterns that separate the features that survived from the ones that quietly faded.

30

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Portfolio

Survival study of 30 AI features across 30 companies

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The market decides, not the roadmap

This study tracks thirty flagship AI features, fifteen from AI native companies and fifteen from established software companies, and asks one question of each: a year or more after it launched, is it still alive and working, or did it fade? Every feature is scored from 0 to 10 on five signals, and the reasoning behind each score is shown in full later in this report.

7.8 Average survival score across all thirty features, on a 0 to 10 scale	4.6–9.3 The full range of scores. Nothing in the set fully died	8.9 Average company conviction, almost flat across winners and laggards alike

The single sharpest finding sits in that last number. **Company conviction barely varies.** Almost every company is deeply committed to its flagship AI feature, which means conviction tells you almost nothing about whether the feature will last. What actually separates the survivors from the faded is whether real people use the feature and whether competitors bothered to copy it. The market decides, not the roadmap.

> **Three things the data says plainly.** First, the features that lasted nearly all have revenue attached, not just usage. Second, the features priced to a customer outcome outscored every other pricing model. Third, being an AI native startup was not a moat: established companies adapted about as well, scoring 7.66 on average against the startups' 7.99.
>
> The rest of this report explains the method in plain terms, ranks all thirty features, shows the analysis behind the findings, sets out seven plays a product team can act on, offers a simple framework for predicting whether a new AI feature will survive, and gives a full scored dossier for every feature.

HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

The method, in plain terms

Every feature is judged on the same five questions. Each question is scored from 0 to 10, and the five are combined into one survival score, also from 0 to 10. A high score means the feature clearly survived and is thriving. A low score means it faded or is struggling. The single number is a summary; the reasoning beside it is the real content.

THE FIVE SIGNALS	WEIGHT	THE PLAIN QUESTION IT ANSWERS
Usage evidence	25%	Do people actually use it?
User sentiment	20%	Do the people who use it like it?
Company conviction	20%	Is the company still investing in it?
Competitive response	15%	Did competitors copy it?
Strategic signal	20%	Is it central to the company's future, or a side feature?

The user side signals (usage and sentiment) carry 45 percent of the weight between them. That is deliberate. A feature has to be used, not just promoted, and weighting the company's own signals too heavily was a draft mistake corrected before scoring began.

The time window is roughly twelve months after launch. A handful of features launched recently enough that the full year is only just complete; those are flagged as a partial window so they are not judged on a track record they have not had time to build.

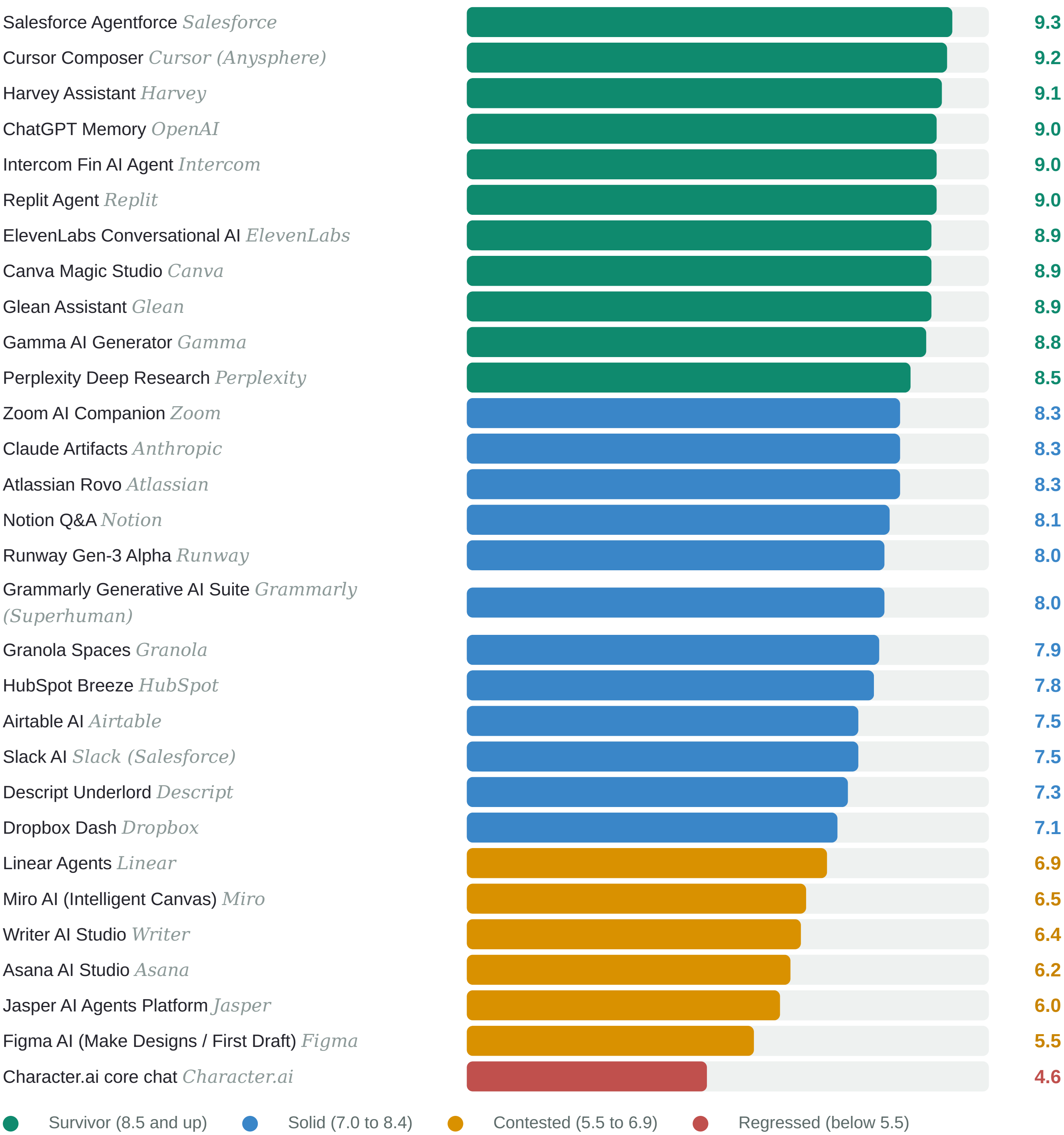
When a signal had no public evidence, two different rules applied. For usage and sentiment, silence was scored as a low 2, because no public sign of use is itself a sign of weak adoption. For company conviction and strategic signal, a missing signal was set aside and the others reweighted, because silence there usually means a company keeping its plans private rather than a failure.

On evidence quality. Where a number came from a company's own reporting rather than an independent source, the dossier says so. Whole product figures (a company's total users, for instance) were never borrowed as proof that one specific feature is used. The scale itself was fixed with three calibration anchors, explained in the methodology at the back.

THE SURVIVAL SCOREBOARD

All thirty, ranked

Every feature, highest survival score to lowest. Colour shows the band: a thriving survivor, a solid survivor, a contested or unproven middle, or a feature that regressed.



THE ANALYSIS

What separated the survivors from the faded

With thirty features scored on five signals each, the interesting question is which signals actually divide the winners from the rest. The answer is clear and a little surprising.

Conviction is the price of entry, not a predictor

Company conviction averaged 8.9 out of 10 and barely moved across the whole set. Only one feature scored below 7 on conviction. In other words, companies are convinced about almost everything they ship as a flagship. So conviction cannot tell you which features will last, because it looks identical for the winners and the laggards. The table below shows how far each signal separated the top ten features from the bottom ten.

SIGNAL	GAP, TOP 10 VS BOTTOM 10	WHAT IT MEANS
Usage evidence	3.6	Most discriminating. The widest gap between winners and laggards.
Competitive response	3.3	Strong. Whether rivals copied it tracks closely with survival.
Strategic signal	2.0	Moderate. Most flagship features are strategically central by definition.
User sentiment	1.8	Moderate. People mostly like what survives, but it is a softer divider.
Company conviction	1.8	Least useful. Nearly every company is convinced, so it barely separates anyone.

Usage and competitive response are the dividers. If you want to know whether an AI feature will survive, watch whether real people use it and whether rivals copy it. Both are signals the company does not control, which is exactly why they are trustworthy.

Pricing tells a story of its own

Grouping the features by how they are priced reveals a clean pattern: the closer the price is tied to the value a customer actually receives, the better the feature did.

PRICING MODEL	FEATURES	AVERAGE SCORE
Priced to an outcome	3	8.7
Usage based pricing	8	7.8
Freemium	5	7.8
Bundled into a plan	7	7.8
Flat per seat	7	7.5

The three features priced to a customer outcome lead every other group. Flat per seat pricing trails. The lesson runs straight into the plays that follow.

The incumbents kept up

The fifteen AI native features averaged 7.99; the fifteen established software features averaged 7.66. The gap is small. The expectation that AI native startups would clearly outlast incumbent features is not supported here. Established companies used their existing base and distribution to ship AI that stuck.

THE PLAYBOOK

Seven plays for shipping AI that lasts

Each play states the lesson, why it matters, the evidence from this study that supports it, and what a product team should actually do. They are ordered from the most important.

PLAY 01

Believe nothing because the company believes it

The play. Treat company conviction as the price of entry, not as evidence a feature will last.

Why it matters. It is the easiest signal to mistake for proof, because companies talk most loudly about the features they are most committed to.

What the evidence shows. Across all thirty features, company conviction averaged 8.9 out of 10 and barely moved (only one feature scored below 7). It looked the same for the winners and the faded. The two signals that actually separated the top ten from the bottom ten were real usage (a 3.6 point gap) and whether rivals copied the feature (a 3.3 point gap).

How to apply it. When you assess a feature, yours or a competitor's, discount the roadmap and the launch post. Ask instead what independent usage you can see and whether anyone has bothered to copy it.

PLAY 02

Look for the dollar figure, not the usage chart

The play. The features that survived almost all have revenue attached, not just engagement.

Why it matters. Usage can be free, inflated, or vanity. Revenue is the market voting with money.

What the evidence shows. The clear winners (Cursor, Replit, Harvey, Glean, ElevenLabs, Gamma, Agentforce, Intercom) each have a hard revenue number tied to the feature. The features stuck in the middle (Writer, Jasper, Miro, Asana AI Studio) are the ones where you can find conviction and even usage claims, but no money.

How to apply it. When forecasting whether an AI feature will last, find the revenue line first. If the only evidence is usage with no dollars, treat it as unproven.

PLAY 03

Price the outcome, not the seat

The play. Features priced to the result a customer gets outscored the ones priced per user.

Why it matters. Outcome pricing ties what the customer pays to the value they receive, which makes the feature easy to keep and hard to cut.

What the evidence shows. The three features priced to an outcome (Intercom Fin, Salesforce Agentforce, HubSpot Breeze) averaged 8.7, the highest of any pricing model, while flat per seat features averaged 7.5, the lowest. Intercom's switch to charging per resolved ticket pushed its revenue retention from 112 to 146 percent.

How to apply it. If your AI feature produces a measurable outcome (a resolved ticket, a qualified lead, a finished draft), price it to that outcome. It both proves value and protects the feature at renewal.

PLAY 04

Bundle to win adoption, but do not call it revenue

The play. Giving an AI feature away inside an existing plan reliably drives adoption, but it is a retention move, not a growth engine.

Why it matters. Teams often bundle and then expect new revenue; the evidence says bundling buys usage and defense, not a new line on the income statement.

What the evidence shows. Zoom gave AI Companion away free and its AI users grew 40 percent in a single quarter; Notion bundled AI into a plan and usage tripled; Atlassian's free Rovo tier drove five million monthly users. All three are strong on adoption and weak on direct AI revenue.

How to apply it. Bundle when the goal is adoption and defending the base against a rival. Do not promise the board new revenue from a feature you are giving away.

PLAY 05

Become infrastructure, not an ornament

The play. Features that other features depend on survive; standalone features are easier to quietly remove.

Why it matters. Dependence creates switching cost inside the product itself, which no competitor can undo for you.

What the evidence shows. ChatGPT Memory scored 9.0 in large part because Projects, Study Mode and the new browser all rely on it; removing it would break them. By contrast, even an excellent but standalone feature such as Claude Artifacts scores a notch lower, because the product would still work without it.

How to apply it. Design your flagship AI feature so other parts of the product lean on it. The more load it bears, the safer it is.

PLAY 06

Being AI native is not a moat

The play. Incumbent software companies adapted to AI about as well as the AI native startups did.

Why it matters. A common assumption is that companies built around AI will outcompete legacy tools. The data does not support it.

What the evidence shows. The fifteen AI native features averaged 7.99; the fifteen traditional SaaS features averaged 7.66. Nearly the same. Incumbents such as Canva, Salesforce, Zoom, Atlassian and Notion shipped AI features that survived just as well, cushioned by their existing base and distribution.

How to apply it. Do not assume a startup wins because it is newer, or that an incumbent is too slow. Judge each feature on usage and revenue, not on the company's vintage.

PLAY 07

Flagship bets get retooled, not killed

The play. Within a year, companies almost never abandon a flagship AI feature; they relaunch, rename, or absorb it into something new.

Why it matters. It changes how you read a stumble. A pause or a bad launch is usually a detour, not a death.

What the evidence shows. Across all thirty features, none stayed dead or paused; the lowest score was 4.6. Figma paused its design generator after a public embarrassment, then relaunched it as First Draft inside a new agent. Character.ai regressed under legal pressure but kept operating. Even the worst cases persisted in altered form.

How to apply it. When a competitor's feature stumbles, do not write it off. Expect a retooled return and plan for it.

LOOKING FORWARD

A field guide for predicting survival

The same patterns that explain the past year can be turned into a simple test for a new AI feature. To estimate whether a feature will survive its first year, ask four questions, weighted by how strongly each one divided winners from laggards in this study.

- **Is there independent usage within months, not just company claims?** This is the heaviest weight. Usage was the single most discriminating signal.
- **Are competitors copying it?** The second heaviest. A feature rivals rush to match is one the market has validated.
- **Is it priced to an outcome?** Outcome priced features led every pricing group, because the price proves the value.
- **Is it becoming infrastructure other features depend on?** Dependence creates switching cost and makes a feature expensive to remove.

Notice what is missing: company conviction. It is necessary but not predictive. Assume it is present in every flagship and look past it.

What the patterns suggest is coming

If these lessons hold, a few things follow for the next wave. Agent features will sort quickly into those that can show audited revenue and production deployments, such as Salesforce Agentforce and the coding and voice agents, and those still selling a vision. Outcome based pricing will spread, because it is the clearest survival signal a team can build in from the start. The bundling wars will intensify, with incumbents giving AI away to defend their base. And in the crowded race to put AI across all of a company's work, the winners will be whoever can attach revenue to it; a feature like Glean, with real revenue, is on firmer ground than a show me bet like Dropbox Dash until Dash posts numbers of its own.

FEATURE DOSSIERS

Every feature, scored signal by signal

Each card shows the survival score, the rating on all five signals with the evidence behind it, and a one line reading of what the year revealed. This is the full reasoning behind every number in the scoreboard.

Salesforce Agentforce *Salesforce · Traditional SaaS · launched 2024-09*

9.3/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.5**	Audited filings show Agentforce revenue going from over 500M to billions with thousands of paid deals, plus an 84 percent resolution rate on its own support.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Strong enterprise conversion from pilots to production, against broad market skepticism about agent ROI.
Company conviction (20%)	**10.0**	The entire company go to market, with executive pay tied to its revenue.
Competitive response (15%)	**9.5**	Defined the enterprise agent category that everyone now answers.
Strategic signal (20%)	**10.0**	It is Salesforce's whole AI story.

Reading. The strongest entry in the set because the evidence is audited, not marketed.

Cursor Composer *Cursor (Anysphere) · AI native · launched 2024-11*

9.2/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.5**	Over 2B in yearly revenue, more than a million paying users, present in most of the Fortune 1000.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Developers largely love it, but a 2025 pricing change caused real anger and a rollback.
Company conviction (20%)	**10.0**	Built its own model and kept shipping agent features; the clearest commitment in the set.
Competitive response (15%)	**9.5**	Forced the whole coding category to respond, from GitHub to Claude Code.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.5**	The agent is the company's entire thesis that the editor is now a fallback.

Reading. When a feature becomes the company's revenue engine, survival is not in question.

Harvey Assistant *Harvey · AI native · launched 2023*

9.1/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.5**	142,000+ lawyers, half the top 100 US firms, and seat counts that double within a year.
User sentiment (20%)	**8.0**	Strong adoption at demanding firms; reviews note both real strengths and the accuracy bar legal work demands.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.5**	Over 1.2B raised, expanding agents and embedded engineering teams inside client firms.
Competitive response (15%)	**8.5**	The blueprint others such as Legora and CoCounsel are measured against.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.5**	The assistant is the core of a fast growing vertical AI company.

Reading. In a high stakes profession, clearing the trust bar once creates fast expansion.

ChatGPT Memory *OpenAI · AI native · launched 2024-02*

9.0/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.0**	Rolled out to free users in 2025; an independent measure put about 73 percent of ChatGPT Atlas sessions as memory enabled (single source).
User sentiment (20%)	**7.0**	Broadly useful, though some power users dislike it building a profile of them.
Company conviction (20%)	**10.0**	OpenAI rebuilt the memory engine in 2026 and doubled capacity, which companies do not do for dead features.
Competitive response (15%)	**9.5**	Memory became table stakes; nearly every rival assistant shipped its own version.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.5**	It is the foundation that Projects, Study Mode and the new browser rely on.

Reading. A feature other features are built on top of is too costly to remove, so it survives.

Intercom Fin AI Agent *Intercom · Traditional SaaS · launched 2023-03*

9.0/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.5**	Passed 100M in yearly revenue across roughly 8,000 businesses, with 40M+ resolved conversations.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	The pay per resolution model is admired, though some call the bill expensive and cheaper rivals exist.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.5**	The company rebuilt itself around AI first support and took on debt to fund it.
Competitive response (15%)	**9.5**	Set the reference for outcome priced AI support that Zendesk, Ada and others answer.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.5**	Fin is the whole strategy.

Reading. Pricing tied to a resolved outcome drove revenue retention from 112 to 146 percent.

Replit Agent *Replit · AI native · launched 2024-09*

9.0/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.5**	Took the company's revenue from a flat 2.8M to roughly 525M, with 50M+ users and most of the Fortune 500 present.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.0**	Strong enthusiasm for letting non engineers build apps, tempered by real reliability incidents.
Company conviction (20%)	**10.0**	Total; the company repositioned entirely around the agent and shipped successive versions.
Competitive response (15%)	**8.5**	Defined the AI builds apps for non engineers lane against Lovable, Bolt and others.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.5**	The agent is the company's whole strategy.

Reading. A feature that resets the revenue curve is the strongest possible survival signal.

ElevenLabs Conversational AI *ElevenLabs · AI native · launched 2024*

8.9/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.0**	Crossed 500M in yearly revenue by early 2026, with growth explicitly attributed to enterprise voice agents.
User sentiment (20%)	**8.0**	Voices regarded as the most human; strong developer and enterprise enthusiasm.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.5**	A relentless shipping pace and a full company rebrand around agents.
Competitive response (15%)	**8.5**	A leader in the hot voice agent wave, with partnerships such as IBM.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.5**	Conversational AI is now the explicit growth engine.

Reading. Moving from a component to a platform is how a single feature vendor avoids commoditization.

Canva Magic Studio *Canva · Traditional SaaS · launched 2023-10*

8.9/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.5**	Canva's AI tools have been used over 10 billion times and one new feature hit 9M uses in a month.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Loved for fast on brand marketing output; called template native for high end creative.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.5**	A 2026 release built on Canva's own design model shows deep investment.
Competitive response (15%)	**8.5**	A category defining consumer rollout that both led and responded to rivals.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.0**	Central to converting free users to Pro.

Reading. The clearest proof that everyday non technical users will adopt and keep AI at massive scale.

Glean Assistant *Glean · AI native · launched 2024-06*

8.9/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.0**	300M in yearly revenue by May 2026, roughly triple in 15 months, with Fortune 500 count nearly doubling.
User sentiment (20%)	**8.0**	Strong analyst and customer recognition; the honest caveat is that time saved is hard to tie to headcount.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.5**	Constant platform investment: a new agent engine, a third generation assistant, model choice.
Competitive response (15%)	**8.5**	A reference point in the AI for work race, though it fights Microsoft and Google head on.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.5**	The assistant is the company.

Reading. Hard revenue plus marquee logos is the strongest survival evidence there is.

Gamma AI Generator *Gamma · AI native · launched 2022*

8.8/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**9.5**	70M users, 102M in yearly revenue, profitable, more than a million new creations a day.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Loved for fast on brand decks; the persistent complaint is broken PowerPoint export and a price rise.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	A major 3.0 release and an AI design agent kept the product moving.
Competitive response (15%)	**8.5**	Held the native AI deck category as a direct rival shut its slides product.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.0**	The describe and get a deck flow is the reason people sign up.

Reading. Being the category reference lets you survive even as giants add the same feature.

Perplexity Deep Research *Perplexity · AI native · launched 2025-02*

8.5/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**8.0**	A core mode of a product serving tens of millions, used heavily by researchers and analysts.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Praised for structured, cited reports, with the usual caution that AI research still needs human checking.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	Continuous upgrades through 2026, including faster models and newer reasoning engines.
Competitive response (15%)	**9.0**	Touched off a wave; the major labs all shipped their own deep research modes.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.0**	The feature that justifies the paid tier and the research assistant positioning.

Reading. Being first to name and ship a category buys durable association even as rivals copy it.

Zoom AI Companion *Zoom · Traditional SaaS · launched 2023-09*

8.3/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**8.5**	Hundreds of thousands of accounts and millions of summaries; AI users grew 40 percent in a single quarter.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Liked for being free and zero setup; pricing volatility is a mild negative.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	A 3.0 release with agentic features and supporting acquisitions.
Competitive response (15%)	**7.5**	Free bundling pressured paid rivals and matched Teams and Meet.
Strategic signal (20%)	**8.5**	The thread tying the beyond meetings strategy together.

Reading. Free bundling reliably drives adoption, but it is a retention win more than a revenue one.

Claude Artifacts *Anthropic · AI native · launched 2024-06*

8.3/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**7.0**	Generally available on all paid plans and inside Projects; precise feature level usage is not public, so it is scored on its own evidence rather than Claude's overall numbers.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Widely described as turning chat into interactive mini apps, though the evidence is indirect.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.5**	Two years of added capability: saved state, embedded live AI, and data connected artifacts.
Competitive response (15%)	**9.0**	Created the pattern; OpenAI and Google shipped their own canvas versions in response.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.0**	A core, visible part of what Claude is.

Reading. It held its lead by extending the capability rather than just matching the copies.

Atlassian Rovo *Atlassian · Traditional SaaS · launched 2024-04*

8.3/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**8.5**	Five million monthly users (audited), with search usage up a hundredfold and thousands of agents built.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Most users say it beats the search they had before; analysts watch for licensed but idle shelfware.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	Bundled into Collections with a free tier to drive adoption, plus continuous expansion.
Competitive response (15%)	**7.5**	Atlassian's entry in the AI across your work race, with an interoperability angle.
Strategic signal (20%)	**8.5**	Central to the System of Work strategy.

Reading. Giving the feature away inside the platform turned reach into genuine usage.

Notion Q&A *Notion · Traditional SaaS · launched 2023-11*

8.1/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**8.0**	AI use tripled after Notion bundled it into the Business plan (single source); the install base is over 100M.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Praised as the strongest part of Notion's AI, with honest limits on large workspaces and file reading.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	A steady march to autonomous agents and enterprise search built on the Q&A layer.
Competitive response (15%)	**7.0**	A strong implementation of the ask your workspace pattern rather than its inventor.
Strategic signal (20%)	**8.5**	Central to the shift from where knowledge is stored to where it is used.

Reading. Removing the price friction can unlock adoption a premium add on never reaches.

Runway Gen-3 Alpha *Runway · AI native · launched 2024-06*

8.0/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**7.0**	Still used as the lower cost workhorse while the Gen-4 line serves higher end work; no public revenue figures.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.0**	Respected by agencies and filmmakers, with the credit based cost a common gripe.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	A rapid succession of newer models shows the line is a priority.
Competitive response (15%)	**8.0**	Set a quality bar the field chased, but now faces intense pressure from Google and others.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.0**	Video generation is the company.

Reading. Shipping first kept Runway top tier but did not produce a monopoly; distribution rich giants caught up.

Grammarly Generative AI Suite *Grammarly (Superhuman) · Traditional SaaS · launched 2023-04*

8.0/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**7.5**	Embedded across roughly a million apps with a very large install base; feature specific numbers are not broken out.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.0**	Broadly trusted, with a lingering question of whether people use the generation features or just the grammar.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.5**	The company bet its entire identity on it, rebranding to Superhuman and acquiring two companies.
Competitive response (15%)	**6.5**	A defensive move against ChatGPT that now competes in the cross app assistant space.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.0**	The generative suite is the bridge that justified the whole reinvention.

Reading. Distribution inside the apps people already write in is a moat ChatGPT cannot easily match.

Granola Spaces *Granola · AI native · launched 2025-05 · partial window*

7.9/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**7.5**	Strong enterprise momentum (250 percent quarterly growth, marquee logos) but the Spaces brand itself is only months old.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.0**	The product is well liked for its no bot approach; the specific feature is too new for deep sentiment.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	The entire enterprise pivot and a 1.5B valuation are built on it.
Competitive response (15%)	**6.5**	Differentiated, but meeting notes are commoditizing, which is what Spaces is meant to escape.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.0**	It is the bet that justifies the valuation.

Reading. Promising and well funded, but scored as young on purpose because the track record is short.

HubSpot Breeze *HubSpot · Traditional SaaS · launched 2024-09*

7.8/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**7.5**	Published customer outcomes such as large hour savings, and its own support resolving a third of tickets with it.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.0**	Positive for small and mid sized teams; minor friction from a retired sub brand and credit costs.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	Breeze is HubSpot's entire AI brand, now on pay per result pricing.
Competitive response (15%)	**7.0**	HubSpot's answer to Agentforce at the smaller end of the market.
Strategic signal (20%)	**8.5**	The central AI consolidation bet.

Reading. Tying price to outcomes is becoming the mark of the AI features that stick.

Airtable AI *Airtable · Traditional SaaS · launched 2024-03*

7.5/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**7.0**	Cobuilder was the fastest adopted feature in Airtable's history; broader stats are mostly the company's own.
User sentiment (20%)	**6.5**	Liked for getting non technical users started, with an honest ceiling on complex needs and external data.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	Very high; Airtable rebuilt itself AI native with new standalone products and an acquisition.
Competitive response (15%)	**6.5**	A differentiated structured data angle, also defending against commoditization.
Strategic signal (20%)	**8.5**	AI is the entire repositioning after a hard stretch.

Reading. A credible turnaround bet on AI for structured data, with conviction ahead of independent proof.

Slack AI *Slack (Salesforce) · Traditional SaaS · launched 2024-02*

7.5/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**7.0**	Basic AI now reaches all paid plans; the strongest internal proof is Salesforce's own near universal staff use (vendor source).
User sentiment (20%)	**6.5**	Useful, but forcing customers off the standalone add on into pricier tiers annoyed some.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.0**	Thirty new AI features in early 2026 and deep wiring into the Agentforce strategy.
Competitive response (15%)	**6.5**	A necessary answer to Microsoft Teams and Copilot rather than a category setter.
Strategic signal (20%)	**8.5**	Slack is now a delivery surface for Salesforce's agents.

Reading. The clean paid signal the project expected was overtaken; Slack chose adoption over a standalone price.

Descript Underlord *Descript · AI native · launched 2025-04*

7.3/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**6.5**	No hard numbers, but consistent reviewer use and real time savings for podcasters and talking head video.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.5**	Positive within its niche, with honest limits on cinematic and effects heavy work.
Company conviction (20%)	**8.0**	Continued investment, including a model picker and new generation features.
Competitive response (15%)	**6.5**	A named, marketable agent to compete with CapCut, Runway and newer editors.
Strategic signal (20%)	**8.0**	The agent is the bet to stay relevant as AI video tools multiply.

Reading. A clear niche plus steady investment can sustain a feature without headline metrics.

Dropbox Dash *Dropbox · Traditional SaaS · launched 2023*

7.1/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**5.5**	Available to 575,000 paying businesses with positive early response, but no disclosed metrics and explicitly pre revenue.
User sentiment (20%)	**6.0**	Early customer response reported as positive (vendor); little independent sentiment yet.
Company conviction (20%)	**9.5**	Maximum; Dropbox is betting the company's narrative on Dash with acquisitions and marketing.
Competitive response (15%)	**5.5**	A repositioning entry against Glean and Microsoft rather than a category setter.
Strategic signal (20%)	**9.0**	It is the entire turnaround bet.

Reading. Huge conviction, unproven results; the sharp contrast with Glean, same thesis with real revenue, is the lesson.

Linear Agents *Linear · Traditional SaaS · launched 2025 · partial window*

6.9/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**6.0**	Qualitative; a reported large cut in time spent filing issues (partner source), with the full agent in beta.
User sentiment (20%)	**7.0**	Linear's design discipline is beloved, and the restrained AI reads as mature.
Company conviction (20%)	**8.0**	A clear issue tracking is dead repositioning around five AI pillars.
Competitive response (15%)	**6.0**	Praised for restraint, but not forcing the category.
Strategic signal (20%)	**7.5**	Agents are central to the AI should reduce friction thesis.

Reading. Disciplined, well integrated AI scores respectably, but thin public proof and a new agent cap the score.

Miro AI (Intelligent Canvas) *Miro · Traditional SaaS · launched 2024*

6.5/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**5.5**	The thinnest evidence of any SaaS entry; mostly announcements and roadmap, with the newest features in beta.
User sentiment (20%)	**6.0**	Limited independent voice; positive directory style reviews.
Company conviction (20%)	**8.0**	Clearly increased, with an AI canvas, workflows and shared AI workspaces.
Competitive response (15%)	**5.5**	Keeping pace with FigJam, Mural and others rather than leading.
Strategic signal (20%)	**7.5**	The AI canvas is central to the multiproduct repositioning.

Reading. Investment is real, but a feature you cannot verify people use cannot score highly, and the score says so.

Writer AI Studio *Writer · AI native · launched 2024*

6.4/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**5.5**	Concrete enterprise proof points, but the numbers are almost all the company's own.
User sentiment (20%)	**5.0**	Almost no independent user voice, which is itself a signal on a sales led product.
Company conviction (20%)	**8.0**	Strong and clear: continued platform investment and backing from Salesforce and Adobe venture arms.
Competitive response (15%)	**5.5**	A differentiated niche player rather than a category setter.
Strategic signal (20%)	**8.0**	The platform is the whole strategy.

Reading. A defensible bet whose adoption is genuinely hard to verify from outside; the score reflects that.

Asana AI Studio *Asana · Traditional SaaS · launched 2024*

6.2/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**6.0**	AI Studio revenue is doubling each quarter but remains tiny in absolute terms, with small case studies.
User sentiment (20%)	**5.5**	Limited independent voice; positive but vendor sourced outcomes.
Company conviction (20%)	**8.0**	High; AI Studio and the coming AI Teammates are the multiproduct bet.
Competitive response (15%)	**5.5**	A follower in AI work management against Monday, ClickUp and Notion.
Strategic signal (20%)	**7.0**	The platform's whole future is staked on it.

Reading. Fast percentage growth off a small base is real progress, not yet proof of a winner.

Jasper AI Agents Platform *Jasper · AI native · launched 2024*

6.0/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**5.5**	Real users report time savings, but there are no public revenue numbers and some call it a dressed up free tool.
User sentiment (20%)	**5.5**	Mixed; Brand Voice is praised, output quality and why not just ChatGPT are recurring complaints.
Company conviction (20%)	**7.0**	The company did fully commit to the agent platform rebrand and publishes annual research.
Competitive response (15%)	**5.0**	More the one responding to commoditization than the one others respond to.
Strategic signal (20%)	**7.0**	The agent platform is the survival bet against commoditized AI writing.

Reading. Committing to a pivot is not the same as proving it worked; the evidence here is thin.

Figma AI (Make Designs / First Draft) *Figma · Traditional SaaS · launched 2024-06*

5.5/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**5.5**	The specific generate a screen feature is still positioned as early exploration, not a headline used feature.
User sentiment (20%)	**5.0**	It carries the reputational scar of the 2024 pause; designers remain lukewarm on full generation.
Company conviction (20%)	**8.0**	High; Figma relaunched it as First Draft and folded it into a new design agent rather than killing it.
Competitive response (15%)	**5.5**	Catch up work in a field it once stumbled in publicly.
Strategic signal (20%)	**7.0**	Part of the design to code agent future.

Reading. A failed launch that recovered into a live but caveated feature; see the methodology note on the anchor change.

Character.ai core chat *Character.ai · AI native · launched 2022*

4.6/10

Usage evidence (25%)	**4.5**	Still a large consumer app, but removing open ended chat for under 18 users cut off its most engaged audience.
User sentiment (20%)	**3.5**	Damaged by a safety crisis and by complaints that characters felt duller after model changes.
Company conviction (20%)	**5.5**	Investing in survival and safety, but it stepped back from the original flagship rather than doubling down.
Competitive response (15%)	**5.0**	Pioneered consumer companionship, but is now more a cautionary tale than a reference.
Strategic signal (20%)	**4.5**	The core experience persists but its standing is impaired by legal and regulatory pressure.

Reading. Pressure on the very behavior that drove engagement can force a feature to regress even when demand exists.

METHODOLOGY AND JUDGMENT CALLS

How this was built, and what it cannot tell you

Honesty about method is part of the credibility of the result, so the judgment calls are documented here rather than hidden.

How the features were scored

Because what happened to these features over the past year is recent and changes constantly, each one was researched against current public sources rather than recalled from memory. For every feature, the five signals were rated, the reasoning was written down with its sources, and the result was logged into a single dataset. The scoring was driven by an AI assistant and reviewed by the author, a deliberate trade of independent research effort for speed and consistency, made knowingly.

The calibration anchors

Three features fixed the scale so the scores stay comparable. Intercom Fin was the high anchor at 9.0, a clear winner. Asana AI Studio was the middle anchor at about 6.1, a real enterprise bet with thin public signal. Both held on fresh evidence. Figma's design generator was the original low anchor at 2.0, set during the period it was publicly paused.

The Figma anchor change

The 2.0 score for Figma was a snapshot from the moment the feature was paused in 2024. Looking across the full year, that snapshot is out of date: Figma relaunched the feature as First Draft, rebuilt it on its own design libraries, and folded it into a new design agent. Because this study measures the full year rather than the worst week, the feature is scored at 5.5, a failed launch that recovered into a live but still caveated capability. The 2.0 now lives on only as a definition on the scale of what a truly abandoned feature would look like. This is a revisable judgment call. A consequence worth stating plainly: once Figma is read across the full year, not one of the thirty features stayed dead or paused, which is itself a finding (flagship bets get retooled, not killed).

Partial window features

Granola Spaces and Linear Agents launched recently enough that their named flagship is only months old, even though the underlying capability is older. Both are flagged and scored as promising but young, rather than judged on a track record they have not had time to earn.

What thirty features can and cannot tell you

This is a pattern study, not a statistical model. With thirty features, the findings are directional regularities, not laws, and they are presented that way. The signals are not independent of the total they compose, so the meaningful analysis is the spread within each signal and the gap between the top and bottom of the set, not a correlation coefficient. A good deal of enterprise evidence is company reported, and is flagged as such wherever it is used. The aim throughout was the reading most likely to be both true and useful, with the uncertainty left visible rather than smoothed over.

Sources

Scoring drew on company earnings filings and investor letters, independent revenue research, product reviews and community discussion, changelogs and release notes, and contemporary news coverage, all from the launch window through to mid 2026. The strongest evidence in the set comes from audited filings (Salesforce, Dropbox, Atlassian, Asana); the weakest from features whose only signal is the company's own marketing, which the dossiers note directly.